SSC MTS 2021 Paper-I question paper with answers

12 July 2022 · Shift 3

69 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +1 for a right answer, –0.25 for a wrong one

The other 31 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20221017140324/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_FinalAnswerKeyMTS2021_17102022.pdf

General English 25 questions

Q.1

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. Elizabeth beat her rival with the gold medal in the 2021 summer Olympics.

(A) with the gold medal in the
(B) 2021 summer Olympics
(C) Elizabeth beat her rival
(D) No error

Q.2

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Grieve

(A) Tame
(B) Assure
(C) Rejoice
(D) Mourn

Q.3

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Insatiable

(A) Urgent
(B) Fulfilled
(C) Greedy
(D) Insistent

Q.4

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. Green tea is good for not only the health but also for _____ skin.

(A) glowing
(B) emotional
(C) caustic
(D) laborious

Q.5

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. "Major hubs of" the information technology industry is the Silicon Valley of Central California.

(A) No improvement required
(B) A major hub of
(C) Major hub by
(D) The majors hub of

Q.6

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the given sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select 'No improvement required'. My mother's sister "work since eight" hours every weekday.

(A) working of eight
(B) works for eight
(C) work for eight
(D) No improvement required

Q.7
Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) Mismatche
(B) Securities
(C) Essentially
(D) Fiscal

Q.8
Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Story of an individual written by himself

(A) Biography
(B) History
(C) Novel
(D) Autobiography

Q.9
The following sentence has been divided into parts. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don't find any error, mark 'No error' as your answer. India has joined / the global fight / among tax evasion.

(A) the global fight
(B) among tax evasion
(C) No error
(D) India has joined

Q.10
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I like eating chocolates, _____ I hate dark ones.

(A) for
(B) but
(C) because
(D) while

Q.11
Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution required.' We made sure our new house "were closer" to a good primary school when moving home last summer.

(A) was close
(B) No substitution required
(C) were closed
(D) was closing

Q.12
Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. The situation turned ugly as the crowd _____ to riot.

(A) begins
(B) begun
(C) beginning
(D) began

Q.13
Select the most appropriate synonym of the underlined word in the given sentence. Some simple changes in eating habits can "alleviate" nausea.

(A) sharpen
(B) plague
(C) exacerbate
(D) relieve

Q.14
Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Chase rainbows

(A) To be unprepared for something
(B) To lose one's patience
(C) To pursue unrealistic goals
(D) To judge someone

Q.15
Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Hold someone or something at bay

(A) Trap or corner a person or animal being hunted or chased
(B) To seek punishment for a person or group
(C) Prevent someone or something from moving closer
(D) To thrive or to grow very successfully

Q.16

Select the most appropriate option to fill in the blank. I _____ wish I hadn't invited him.

(A) about
(B) else
(C) almost
(D) not

Q.17

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Alleviate

(A) Soothe
(B) Ameliorate
(C) Aggravate
(D) Destroy

Q.18

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. One of them may contain an error. Select the part that contains the error from the given options. If you don’t find any error, mark ‘No error’ as your answer. She is brave than any other girl in the office.

(A) She is brave
(B) in the office
(C) No error
(D) than any other girl

Q.19

Select the option that will improve the underlined part of the sentence. In case no improvement is needed, select ‘No improvement required’. Why are you “looking on my” face like this?

(A) looked at my
(B) No improvement required
(C) looking on mine
(D) looking at my

Q.20

Select the option that corrects the incorrectly spelt words in the given sentence. Ventilaton system is mising in this room.

(A) Ventiltion system is missing in this room.
(B) Ventilation system is mising in this rum.
(C) Ventilation system is missing in this room.
(D) Wentilation system is mesing in this room.

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Ants, like most insects, have (1) _____ are known as compound eyes. This means their eyes have multiple lenses, (2) _____ in general, most species of ant do not have particularly great eyes for seeing (3) _____ far. Ants can detect movement and see the areas around them, but (4) _____ more on senses and information they get from their legs and antennae (5) _____ from their eyes.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) whose
(B) how
(C) what
(D) who

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Ants, like most insects, have (1) _____ are known as compound eyes. This means their eyes have multiple lenses, (2) _____ in general, most species of ant do not have particularly great eyes for seeing (3) _____ far. Ants can detect movement and see the areas around them, but (4) _____ more on senses and information they get from their legs and antennae (5) _____ from their eyes.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) whether
(B) so
(C) but
(D) rather

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Ants, like most insects, have (1) _____ are known as compound eyes. This means their eyes have multiple lenses, (2) _____ in general, most species of ant do not have particularly great eyes for seeing (3) _____ far. Ants can detect movement and see the areas around them, but (4) _____ more on senses and information they get from their legs and antennae (5) _____ from their eyes.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) some
(B) many
(C) enough
(D) very

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Ants, like most insects, have (1) _____ are known as compound eyes. This means their eyes have multiple lenses, (2) _____ in general, most species of ant do not have particularly great eyes for seeing (3) _____ far. Ants can detect movement and see the areas around them, but (4) _____ more on senses and information they get from their legs and antennae (5) _____ from their eyes.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) calculate
(B) shout
(C) rely
(D) struggle

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Ants, like most insects, have (1) _____ are known as compound eyes. This means their eyes have multiple lenses, (2) _____ in general, most species of ant do not have particularly great eyes for seeing (3) _____ far. Ants can detect movement and see the areas around them, but (4) _____ more on senses and information they get from their legs and antennae (5) _____ from their eyes.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) than
(B) when
(C) then
(D) thus

General Intelligence and Reasoning 19 questions

Q.1

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.
34, 102, 612, 5508, ?

(A) 64046
(B) 68098
(C) 66096
(D) 68026

Q.2

In a supermarket there are seven toys, A, K, L, P, M, S and T, of different heights. L is taller than S, but shorter than M. K is taller than P. A is taller than only T. L is shorter than only three toys. T is the shortest and M is taller than K. The height of S is shorter than how many toys?

(A) Two
(B) Three
(C) Four
(D) One

Q.3

Select the number from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series.
45, 46, 50, 59, 75, ?

(A) 95
(B) 100
(C) 105
(D) 90

Q.4

In a certain code language, 'KING' is coded as '16181320', and 'HOP' is coded as '191211'. How will 'STA' be coded in that language?

(A) 8627
(B) 8926
(C) 8276
(D) 8726

Q.7

Select the option that is related to the fourth number in the same way as the first number is related to the second number and fifth number is related to sixth number. 11 : 1000 :: ? : 1728 :: 9 : 512

(A) 15
(B) 7
(C) 5
(D) 13

Q.8

In a certain code language, 'GREATR' is written as 'OZMIBZ', and 'POINTA' is written as 'XWQVBI'. How will 'FORTAP' be written in that language?

(A) NWZBHY
(B) NWZBIX
(C) NYZBIX
(D) NXZBIX

Q.9

Six friends A, B, C, D, E and F are sitting around a circular table facing the centre (not necessarily in the same order). A sits third to the left of D. D sits to the immediate right of B. B sits second to the left of E. C sits second to the right of F. Who sits second to the right of A?

(A) C
(B) B
(C) E
(D) F

Q.10

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: No basket is a trolley. No trolley is a suitcase. Conclusions: I. Some baskets being suitcases is a possibility. II. Some suitcases are baskets.

(A) Only conclusion I follows
(B) Both conclusions I and II follow
(C) Only conclusion II follows
(D) Neither conclusion I nor II follows

Q.11

After interchanging the given two digits 4 and 6, what will be the value of the following equation? $5 + 3 \times 4 - 6 \div 2 = ?$

(A) 15
(B) 21
(C) 41
(D) 35

Q.12

What will come in the place of '?' in the following equation, if '×' and ' – ' are interchanged and also '+' and '÷' are interchanged? $27 \times 8 - 3 \div 4 + 2 = ?$

(A) 5
(B) 2
(C) 1
(D) 7

Q.13

Eight girls A, B, C, D, E, F, G and H are sitting in a row, facing towards the north (but not necessarily in the same order). Neither C nor D is at the extreme ends of the row. H is at the extreme right end of the row. Only E is sitting between D and F. Only G is sitting between F and H. C and A are the immediate neighbours of B.Which of the following statements is/are correct? I. D is fourth to the left of H. II. D is the immediate neighbour of B.

(A) Only I
(B) Both I and II
(C) Only II
(D) Neither I nor II

Q.14

Read the given statements and conclusions carefully. Assuming that the information given in the statements is true, even if it appears to be at variance with commonly known facts, decide which of the given conclusions logically follow(s) from the statements. Statements: I. No X is L. II. All M are X. Conclusions: I. No L is X. II. No L is M. III. All M are L.

(A) All the conclusions follow
(B) Only conclusion III follows
(C) Only conclusions I and II follow
(D) Only conclusions II and III follow

Q.16

In a certain code language, 'BALL' is coded as '27' and 'BACK' is coded as '17'. How will 'RACE' be coded in that language?

(A) 27
(B) 22
(C) 17
(D) 37

Q.17

Select the letter-cluster from among the given options that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. AAI, AEI, AII, AOI, ?

(A) AUI
(B) EAI
(C) IAA
(D) IIA

Q.18

Select the option in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following sets. NOTE: Operations should be performed on the whole numbers, without breaking down the numbers into its constituent digits. E.g. 13 – Operations on 13 such as adding /deleting /multiplying etc. to 13 can be performed. Breaking down 13 into 1 and 3 and then performing mathematical operations on 1 and 3 is not allowed) (48, 8, 12); (42, 6, 14)

(A) (88, 22, 4)
(B) (62, 12, 2)
(C) (44, 22, 4)
(D) (36, 18, 2)

Q.21

In a certain code language, 'EARTH' is written as '5118208' and 'BOOK' is written as '2151511'. How will 'COUNTRY' be written in that language?

(A) 3152114201825
(B) 3152114201725
(C) 3152114191825
(D) 3152114201824

Q.22

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. BJ : HP :: TQ : ?

(A) YW
(B) YX
(C) ZX
(D) ZW

Q.23

Select the option in which the pair of letter-clusters share the same relationship as that shared by the given letter-clusters. FAIR : GYJP

(A) RANK : SYPI
(B) TOUR : UNVP
(C) CROW : DPPU
(D) MINT : NGMR

Q.25

Select the option that is related to the fifth letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster and the fourth letter-cluster is related to the third letter-cluster. MET : NGW :: SAF : TCI :: YEL : ?

(A) AGO
(B) ZGN
(C) ZHO
(D) ZGO

General Awareness 25 questions

Q.1

According to the Indian Constitution, the House of People shall consist of not more than _____ members to represent the Union territories.

(A) thirty
(B) twenty
(C) fifteen
(D) thirty-five

Q.2

In which state of India is the Wangala festival celebrated?

(A) Meghalaya
(B) Kerala
(C) Goa
(D) Jharkhand

Q.3

Who among the following Chahamana ruler defeated Sultan Muhammad Ghori in 1191?

(A) Vigraharaja III
(B) Ajayaraja II
(C) Prithviraja III
(D) Durlabharaja III

Q.4

In which year was Sati banned in India?

(A) 1829
(B) 1824
(C) 1826
(D) 1831

Q.5

Who among the following was the founder of the Rashtrakuta dynasty?

(A) Dhruva
(B) Dhantidurga
(C) Govinda III
(D) Amoghavarsha

Q.6

'The White Tiger provides' a darkly humorous perspective of India’s class struggle in a globalised world. It is written by _____.

(A) Shashi Tharoor
(B) Amitav Ghosh
(C) Aravind Adiga
(D) Vikram Seth

Q.7

In basketball, a free-throw is worth how many points?

(A) 1
(B) 2
(C) 3
(D) 4

Q.8
Bidar Fort is situated in which state of India?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Rajasthan
(C) Meghalaya
(D) Karnataka

Q.9
Which of the following is NOT an example of Pteridophyta?

(A) Funaria
(B) Selaginella
(C) Equisetum
(D) Pteris

Q.10
The plate movements on earth are classified into _____ types.

(A) three
(B) two
(C) five
(D) six

Q.11
Who among the following became the Brand Ambassador of Khadi Prakritik Paint in July 2021?

(A) Narendra Singh Tomar
(B) Rajnath Singh
(C) Nitin Gadkari
(D) Arjun Munda

Q.12
How many organs of government are there according to the Indian Constitution?

(A) Two
(B) Four
(C) One
(D) Three

Q.13
The Indian census is generally held every _____.

(A) tenth year
(B) fourth year
(C) fifth year
(D) seventh year

Q.14
As announced in the Union Budget of Financial Year 2022, corporate surcharge was reduced from 12% to _____.

(A) 7%
(B) 8%
(C) 1%
(D) 9%

Q.15
As per Census 2011, which of the following union territories of India has the lowest population?

(A) Daman and Diu
(B) Delhi
(C) Chandigarh
(D) Lakshadweep

Q.16
'Waghya Murali' dance, associated with Lord Khandoba, originated in which state of India?

(A) Maharashtra
(B) Bihar
(C) Rajasthan
(D) Gujarat

Q.17
Who among the following is the first singer to be presented with India's highest civilian honour, the Bharat Ratna?

(A) Ustad Ali Akbar Khan
(B) Hariprasad Chaurasia
(C) Madurai Shanmukhavadivu Subbulakshmi
(D) Bismillah Khan

Q.18

Where was the Formula One 2013 Indian Grand Prix held?

(A) Kari Motor Speedway
(B) Chicane Circuit
(C) Madras Motor Race Track
(D) Buddh International Circuit

Q.19

Of the options listed below, the speed of sound is highest in _____ at 25°C.

(A) Ethanol
(B) Aluminium
(C) Oxygen
(D) Hydrogen

Q.20

The core of the earth is mainly made up of _____.

(A) nickel and silica
(B) silica and magnesium
(C) nickel and iron
(D) silica and alumina

Q.21

PM-DevINE is the Prime Minister's development initiative for _____ India.

(A) south-east
(B) north-east
(C) south-west
(D) north-west

Q.22

As per Census 2011, under which of the following ranges does the literacy rate in India fall?

(A) 90% - 95%
(B) 50% - 55%
(C) 30% - 35%
(D) 70% - 75%

Q.23

Who among the following emphasised the worship of God as Nirankar (formless) in Punjab, India?

(A) Guru Gobind Singh
(B) Maharaja Ranjit Singh
(C) Baba Dayal Das
(D) Baba Ram Singh

Q.24

Starch in potatoes reacts with _____, turning to a blue colour.

(A) fluorine
(B) Bromine
(C) Iodine
(D) Chlorine

Q.25

Indrani Rahman was associated with which classical dance of India? I. Bharatanatyam dance; II. Odissi dance

(A) Neither I nor II
(B) Both I and II
(C) Only II
(D) Only I

Answer key

General English

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(D)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(A)**
Q.19 **(D)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(C)**	Q.23 **(D)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(A)**					

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(B)**	Q.4 **(D)**	Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**
Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(B)**	Q.12 **(A)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(C)**
Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(C)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**
Q.25 **(D)**					

General Awareness

Q.1 **(B)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(C)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(A)**	Q.10 **(A)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(A)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(B)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(B)**	Q.22 **(D)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(C)**
Q.25 **(B)**					

Explanations

General English

Q.1 · Answer (A) with the gold medal in the

One beats a rival 'to' a prize, not 'with' it: 'Elizabeth beat her rival to the gold medal'.

Q.2 · Answer (D) Mourn

To 'grieve' is to feel deep sorrow, especially over a death: to 'mourn'. 'Rejoice' is its opposite.

Q.3 · Answer (B) Fulfilled

'Insatiable' means impossible to satisfy, so its opposite is 'fulfilled', that is satisfied. 'Greedy' is close to a synonym.

Q.4 · Answer (A) glowing

Green tea is said to give 'glowing', that is healthy and radiant, skin. 'Caustic' means burning and 'laborious' needing hard work, and skin is not 'emotional'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) A major hub of

The singular verb 'is' and the one Silicon Valley need a singular subject: 'A major hub of the information technology industry is the Silicon Valley'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) works for eight

The singular subject 'my mother's sister' takes 'works', and a length of time takes 'for', not 'since': 'works for eight hours'.

Q.7 · Answer (A) Mismatche

The correct spelling is 'mismatch', with no final 'e'.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Autobiography

An autobiography is the story of a person's life written by that person; a biography is written by someone else.

Q.9 · Answer (B) among tax evasion

One fights 'against' something: 'the global fight against tax evasion'.

Q.10 · Answer (B) but

SSC's key gives 'but', which introduces an exception to the first clause: chocolates in general are liked, the dark ones are not. 'For' and 'because' would give a reason; 'while' (whereas) can also mark a contrast, though 'but' is the natural link for an exception like this.

Q.11 · Answer (A) was close

'House' is singular, so the verb is 'was': 'our new house was close to a good primary school'. 'Were closed' and 'was closing' change the sense.

Q.12 · Answer (D) began

The sentence is in the past ('turned'), so the simple past 'began' is needed; 'begun' is the past participle and would need 'had'.

Q.13 · Answer (D) relieve

To 'alleviate' is to make pain or discomfort less severe: to 'relieve'. 'Exacerbate' means the opposite.

Q.14 · Answer (C) To pursue unrealistic goals

To 'chase rainbows' is to pursue goals or hopes that can never be realised.

Q.15 · Answer (C) Prevent someone or something from moving closer

To 'hold someone or something at bay' is to keep them from coming closer or doing harm.

Q.16 · Answer (C) almost

'I almost wish' softens the regret: the speaker very nearly regrets the invitation. None of the other words fits before 'wish'.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Aggravate
To 'alleviate' is to make something less severe, and to 'aggravate' is to make it worse. 'Soothe' and 'ameliorate' are close in meaning to 'alleviate'.

Q.18 · Answer (A) She is brave
A comparison with 'than any other' needs the comparative: 'She is braver than any other girl in the office.'

Q.19 · Answer (D) looking at my
One looks 'at' a person or thing: 'Why are you looking at my face like this?' 'Looked' does not fit after 'are'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) Ventilation system is missing in this room.
The correct spellings are 'ventilation' and 'missing'; the other sentences misspell 'ventilation', 'missing' or 'room'.

Q.21 · Answer (C) what
'What' introduces a noun clause meaning 'the things that': ants have 'what are known as compound eyes'.

Q.22 · Answer (C) but
The eyes have many lenses, 'but' they still do not see well: the two clauses contrast.

Q.23 · Answer (D) very
'Very' modifies the adverb 'far': ants cannot see 'very far'.

Q.24 · Answer (C) rely
One 'relies on' something: ants 'rely more on' the senses of their legs and antennae.

Q.25 · Answer (A) than
'More' in a comparison is followed by 'than': more on their legs and antennae 'than from their eyes'.

General Intelligence and Reasoning

Q.1 · Answer (C) 66096
The multipliers rise by 3: 34 × 3 = 102, 102 × 6 = 612, 612 × 9 = 5508 and 5508 × 12 = 66096.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Four
T is the shortest and A next, and L, shorter than only three, is fourth from the top. As S is shorter than L, those three can only be M, K and P (M > K > P), so S is fifth. S is shorter than four toys: M, K, P and L.

Q.3 · Answer (B) 100
The differences are the squares 1, 4, 9, 16; the next is 25: 75 + 25 = 100.

Q.4 · Answer (D) 8726
Each letter is written as its place in the reversed alphabet (27 minus its place): K I N G → 16 18 13 20 and H O P → 19 12 11. So S T A → 8 7 26: 8726.

Q.7 · Answer (D) 13
Each number is paired with the cube of one less than itself: $(11 - 1)^3 = 1000$ and $(9 - 1)^3 = 512$. As $1728 = 12^3$, the missing number is 13.

Q.8 · Answer (B) NWZBIX
Each letter moves 8 places forward, wrapping round after Z: G → O, R → Z, T → B, A → I. So F O R T A P → N W Z B I X.

Q.9 · Answer (B) B
Taking the seats in order to each person's left, the arrangement is D, B, C, A, F, E (and back to D). Going to A's right, C is first and B second.

Q.10 · Answer (A) Only conclusion I follows
Both statements are negative and say nothing about baskets and suitcases together, so the two may or may not overlap: the possibility in I holds, but II is not certain.

Q.11 · Answer (B) 21
After interchanging 4 and 6: 5 + 3 × 6 – 4 ÷ 2 = 5 + 18 – 2 = 21.

Q.12 · Answer (A) 5
After interchanging the signs: 27 – 8 × 3 + 4 ÷ 2 = 27 – 24 + 2 = 5.

Q.13 · Answer (A) Only I
H is at the right end, with G, F, E and D to its left in that order. B sits between C and A in the first three seats, and as C is not at an end, the row is A B C D E F G H. D is fourth to the left of H, but B is not next to D: only I is true.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Only conclusions I and II follow
'No X is L' converts to 'No L is X' (I). As every M is an X and no X is an L, no M is an L, so no L is an M (II), and III is false.

Q.16 · Answer (A) 27
The code is the sum of the letters' places in the alphabet: BALL = 2 + 1 + 12 + 12 = 27 and BACK = 2 + 1 + 3 + 11 = 17. So RACE = 18 + 1 + 3 + 5 = 27.

Q.17 · Answer (A) AUI
The first and last letters stay A and I while the middle letter runs through the vowels A, E, I, O, U: AUI.

Q.18 · Answer (C) (44, 22, 4)
The first number is half the product of the other two: 8 × 12 ÷ 2 = 48 and 6 × 14 ÷ 2 = 42. Likewise 22 × 4 ÷ 2 = 44.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 3152114201825
Each letter is written as its place in the alphabet: E A R T H → 5 1 18 20 8 and B O O K → 2 15 15 11. So C O U N T R Y → 3 15 21 14 20 18 25: 3152114201825.

Q.22 · Answer (D) ZW
Each letter moves 6 places forward: B → H and J → P. So T → Z and Q → W: ZW.

Q.23 · Answer (C) CROW : DPPU
The letters move +1, –2, +1, –2: F A I R → G Y J P. Likewise C R O W → D P P U.

Q.25 · Answer (D) ZGO
The letters move +1, +2 and +3: M E T → N G W and S A F → T C I. So Y E L → Z G O.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (B) twenty
Article 81(1)(b) allows not more than twenty members of the House of the People (Lok Sabha) to represent the Union territories.

Q.2 · Answer (A) Meghalaya
Wangala, the 'hundred drums' festival, is the post-harvest festival of the Garo people of Meghalaya, held in honour of the sun god Saljong.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Prithviraja III
Prithviraja III (Prithviraj Chauhan) defeated Muhammad Ghori in the First Battle of Tarain in 1191; Ghori defeated him at Tarain the next year.

Q.4 · Answer (A) 1829
Lord William Bentinck's Bengal Sati Regulation (Regulation XVII) of 1829 declared sati illegal, a reform Raja Ram Mohan Roy had long campaigned for.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Dhantidurga
Dantidurga founded the Rashtrakuta dynasty in the mid-8th century, overthrowing the Chalukyas of Badami. Dhruva, Govinda III and Amoghavarsha were later Rashtrakuta kings.

Q.6 · Answer (C) Aravind Adiga
'The White Tiger', Aravind Adiga's first novel, won the Booker Prize in 2008.

Q.7 · Answer (A) 1
A successful free throw scores 1 point; a field goal scores 2 points, or 3 from beyond the three-point line.

Q.8 · Answer (D) Karnataka
Bidar Fort stands in Bidar, in northern Karnataka; the Bahmani sultans made Bidar their capital in the 15th century and rebuilt the fort.

Q.9 · Answer (A) Funaria
Funaria is a moss, a bryophyte. Selaginella, Equisetum (horsetail) and Pteris (a fern) are pteridophytes.

Q.10 · Answer (A) three
Plate movements are grouped by their boundaries into three types: divergent (plates moving apart), convergent (moving together) and transform (sliding past each other).

Q.11 · Answer (C) Nitin Gadkari
On 6 July 2021 Nitin Gadkari, then Union Minister for MSME, opened KVIC's automated Khadi Prakritik Paint unit in Jaipur and declared himself brand ambassador of the paint, which is made from cow dung.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Three
The Constitution sets up three organs of government: the legislature, the executive and the judiciary.

Q.13 · Answer (A) tenth year
India's census is decennial, held once every ten years (1951, 1961 and so on to 2011).

Q.14 · Answer (A) 7%
SSC's key gives 7%: the Union Budget 2022-23, presented on 1 February 2022, cut the surcharge on co-operative societies with income above ₹1 crore and up to ₹10 crore from 12% to 7%, the rate companies in that band already paid. The question calls it the corporate surcharge.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Lakshadweep
Census 2011 counted 64,473 people in Lakshadweep, the fewest of any Union territory.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Maharashtra
Waghya Murali is a folk dance of Maharashtra performed by the waghyas and muralis, devotees dedicated to Khandoba, whose chief temple is at Jejuri.

Q.17 · Answer (C) Madurai Shanmukhavadivu Subbulakshmi
The Carnatic singer M. S. Subbulakshmi received the Bharat Ratna in 1998, the first musician to be given it. Bismillah Khan, a shehnai player, received it in 2001.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Buddh International Circuit
The Indian Grand Prix, held from 2011 to 2013, was run at the Buddh International Circuit in Greater Noida, Uttar Pradesh.

Q.19 · Answer (B) Aluminium
Sound travels fastest in solids: at 25°C about 6420 m/s in aluminium, against about 1284 m/s in hydrogen, 1207 m/s in ethanol and 316 m/s in oxygen.

Q.20 · Answer (C) nickel and iron
The earth's core is made mainly of nickel and iron, which is why it is called the 'nife' layer.

Q.21 · Answer (B) north-east
The Prime Minister's Development Initiative for North-East Region (PM-DevINE) was announced in the Union Budget 2022-23 to fund infrastructure and social development projects in the North-East.

Q.22 · Answer (D) 70% - 75%
Census 2011 put India's literacy rate at 74.04%, within the 70%-75% range.

Q.23 · Answer (C) Baba Dayal Das

Baba Dayal Das founded the Nirankari movement in the 19th century, preaching the worship of God as Nirankar, the formless one. Baba Ram Singh led the Namdhari (Kuka) movement.

Q.24 · Answer (C) Iodine

Iodine forms a blue-black complex with starch, the usual test for starch in foods such as potatoes.

Q.25 · Answer (B) Both I and II

Indrani Rahman trained in several classical forms, Bharatanatyam among them, and was one of the first professional dancers to bring Odissi to the stage, performing it in India and abroad.

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